

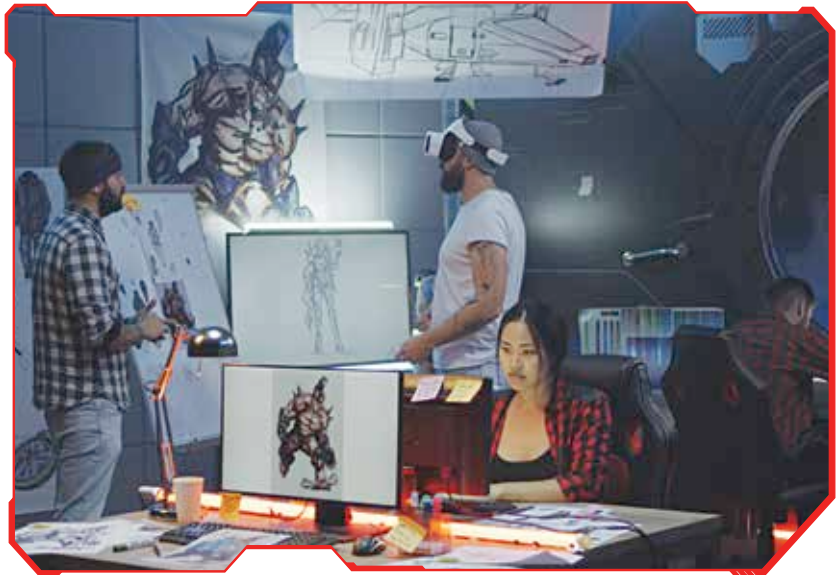
game designer, let us look at the career path, starting with the degrees and certifications that you need to pursue during your quest to become a game designer.

The degree of success

Like it is with any career, which is a confluence of creativity and technical skills, there is formal education that helps you get started. You can think of it as a tutorial, after completing which you get a starter pack that will help you build your character in a game. The only difference here is that the degree, at least at the undergraduate level, will allow you the opportunity to hone your skills and try out more than what you had set to achieve. Some have even gone on to say that about 80 percent of game designers have an undergraduate degree.

When looking at your home ground, which is India, gaming and its related careers are such a new thing that you might be under the impression that there won't be enough on offer. However, the truth is that the industry and the education sector have evolved so rapidly that you will find a plethora of opportunities to learn game design as a degree.

Some of the top institutions and courses that are available in India at the time of writing this article are –



1. B.Sc and M.Sc in Game Design and Development by AFT University
2. Advanced Program in Interactive Design and Games, Advanced Program in Game Design and Integration, Program in Mobile Game Design and Integration, Program in Immersive Design by MAAC
3. Certificate in Toys & Game Design (TGD) by NIFT Delhi
4. UG Program in Game Design Communication Design and Technology by Pearl Academy, Delhi
5. B.Des. in Game Design by UPES
6. BDes in Game Design by Whistling Woods International

7. M.Des. in Digital Game Design by NID Bangalore

These are some of the courses that are offered. If you are doing your research, you find institutes across the country that offer courses that will help you land a job as a game designer.

When you are taking these courses, depending on the institute that you choose, the specialisations, and a host of other factors, the things that you are taught will be different. However, some of the key areas that will be in focus in most of the courses are –

- Game UI and general framework production
- Target audience identification and analysis
- 3D and 2D game prototyping and code development
- Level design
- Platform identification and analysis
- Art direction

During your course, you will also be taken through different software tools that are used for game development. These include programming environments, art and design software, and industry standard game engines. Essentially, you need to be a jack of all trades. Do not come at me with – A jack of all trades is master of none. The complete phrase is – A jack of all trades is a master of none, but oftentimes better than a master of one.

